Exam tips

The cross-references are intended to take you straight to the material that will help you to answer the questions.

Re-read pages 16–22.

(a) (i) Source A suggests that a fixed limit to the territory allotted to the Jews might lessen Arab opposition as it implies a limit to the amount of immigration. Also, the fact that it is a UN solution suggests that it is final.

(ii) To answer this question, first explain what the UNSCOP proposal for Jerusalem was. Then explain why it caused such concern. On what conditions might the Jewish Agency recommend acceptance of the plan?

(b) First, you need to explain the message of Source B. What does the cartoonist think will happen when the British mandate is ended? Does your interpretation of the cartoon support the view, in Source A, of two competing national groups with opposing political interests? Is there any similarity in the cartoonist's view of Britain's role and the effect that partition, in UNSCOP's view, might have?

(c) Source C: explain who the author was and how representative of Arab opinion you think he was. Explain why he focuses on the Balfour Declaration. How, in his opinion, should the UN have acted over Palestine? What had the UN done wrong? What light do these views throw on actions taken by the Arabs in the months ahead?

Source E: what is the value, and what are the limitations, of a historian's view? And, specifically, of an Israeli and a 'revisionist' historian? (For definition of 'revisionist' see the glossary.) What is his main point? How does this add to our understanding of the origins of the Arab–Jewish conflict?

(d) Sources A, C and E all provide some support, even if indirectly, for the view that it was the Palestinian Arab refusal to accept the UN partition plan that led to increased conflict.

- Source A recognises that conflict originated in the clash of two 'nationalisms' but that it was the Arabs who opposed partition. It also believes, rather optimistically, that a UN solution might lessen the opposition and, by implication, the danger of conflict.
- Source C shows that the Arabs believed that the Balfour Declaration and the UN partition plan were both illegal, i.e. that Britain and the UN bear responsibility for the conflict. You should, however, explain how this view might suggest a reason for refusing to accept the plan.
- Source E: for what, according to the author, does the Palestinian Arab refusal provide a pretext? Does his view suggest that it was primarily the Arabs who were responsible for increased conflict? Your own knowledge will be particularly useful here, e.g. about the fighting within the territory to be allotted to the Jews (pages 21–2).